



Week 7 Knowledge Check

Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery

Technical Product Manager Academy



How This Works

12 questions across the week — outputs vs outcomes, Agile values, ADO discipline, outcome tracking, value stream mapping, bottleneck removal.

Commit to an answer **before** the reveal. Retrieval is the point.

? Question 1

Which of the following is a true *outcome* rather than an output?

- A) "Reconcile flow shipped July 15"
- B) "We delivered all 23 user stories in the sprint"
- C) "Dispatchers spend 30 minutes less per shift"
- D) "The outcome is shipping the feature"



Answer 1 — C

"Dispatchers spend 30 minutes less per shift."

That's what *changed for the user*. A and B are outputs; D is an output dressed as an outcome.

? Question 2

The Agile value "working software over comprehensive documentation" most accurately means:

- A) PRDs, TCDs, and TMDs are waste and should be dropped
- B) Documentation is valuable, but subordinate to working software
- C) Teams should stop writing plans
- D) Daily stand-ups replace written docs



Answer 2 — B

Documentation is valuable, but subordinate to working software.

"While there is value in the items on the right, we value the items on the left more." The docs support working software — they aren't waste.

? Question 3 — True / False

A counter-outcome names a result you *don't* want — a guardrail signaling you may have won the primary outcome for the wrong reasons.

Answer 3 — True

Counter-outcomes are the **guardrails** (inherited from the NS Defense Card).

Example: reconcile time drops, but support tickets rise > 20% — you won the primary by adding new pain.

? Question 4

The correct ADO 4-level hierarchy, top to bottom, is:

- A) Feature → Epic → User Story → Task
- B) Epic → Feature → User Story → Task
- C) Epic → User Story → Feature → Task
- D) Epic → Feature → Task → User Story



Answer 4 — B

Epic → Feature → User Story → Task.

Don't go deeper than 4 levels — and don't promote a Task to a User Story just to "make it visible."

? Question 5 — True / False

A user story estimated at more than 13 story points should be split before it enters a sprint.

Answer 5 — True

Stories over **13 points** are too vague to estimate. **Split them.**

Story points are a learning and calibration tool — even imperfect estimates beat no estimates.

? Question 6

Which of the 5 essential queries is high-leverage because it catches forgotten work?

- A) Open in current sprint
- B) Blocked
- C) Stale (no movement $>$ N days)
- D) Done in this sprint

Answer 6 — C

Stale (no movement $>$ N days).

It catches the work that quietly rots in the backlog. Save all 5 queries in a shared folder — they become the team's heartbeat.

? Question 7

In the output / outcome / leading-indicator "triple," the *leading indicator* is:

- A) The feature that shipped
- B) The final business result measured at 30–90 days
- C) The early signal you can watch before the outcome lands
- D) The number of stories completed this sprint



Answer 7 — C

The early signal you can watch before the outcome lands.

e.g., first-attempt completion $\geq 80\%$ by week 2. Without it, you wait 30 days to learn the outcome failed.

? Question 8 — True / False

"If a metric has no cadence, it has no audience."

Answer 8 — True

Every metric needs a **cadence** tied to a real **audience**.

Daily → engineers. Sprint → triad + eng lead. Monthly → TPM + PM director.

Quarterly → leadership. No cadence = nobody owns looking.

? Question 9

Flow efficiency is calculated as:

- A) Lead time / process time $\times 100\%$
- B) Process time / lead time $\times 100\%$
- C) WIP / throughput
- D) Throughput / cycle time



Answer 9 — B

Process time / lead time × 100%.

Hands-on time divided by total time including waiting. Single-digit percentages are typical — that's the startling number that motivates the whole VSM.

? Question 10 — True / False

Lean's foundational claim is that most of the time work spends in a system is spent being *actively worked on*, not waiting.

Answer 10 — False

The opposite: most time is **waiting**, not being worked on.

A story with 2 hours of coding may sit 3 weeks. Optimize the waiting and you save weeks; optimize coding time and you save minutes.

? Question 11

Per the Theory of Constraints (Goldratt), a system's throughput is limited by:

- A) The sum of all the slow steps
- B) Exactly one bottleneck at a time
- C) The team's average velocity
- D) The number of code reviewers

Answer 11 — B

Exactly one bottleneck at a time.

Optimize anything else and you just pile inventory in front of the constraint.
Find it, move it, then find the next one.

? Question 12

What separates a real bottleneck-removal experiment from a wish?

- A) A named owner plus a team-wide announcement
- B) A hypothesis with a measurable success criterion (baseline → target → window)
- C) Broad agreement that the change "feels better"
- D) A longer sprint to give it room

Answer 12 — B

A hypothesis with a measurable success criterion (baseline → target → window).

"We'll see if it feels better" is not an experiment. Vibes don't decide — the number does.



That's Week 7

Score yourself — but the real check is whether you can *use* these on your next sprint.